Charcuterie Lab

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Top Picks: the best brand of everything

Our #1 and best-value pick from all 124 buying guides. Tick what you need and take it to the store.

WHAT YOU'RE BUYING	OUR #1 PICK	BEST VALUE	SCORE
CHEESE			
☐ **Brie**	Fromager d'Affinois	Trader Joe's Brie	4.4
☐ **Cheddar**	Kerrygold Reserve Cheddar	Trader Joe's Unexpected Ched…	4.8
☐ **Manchego**	Kirkland Signature Manchego DOP (6 mon…	Trader Joe's Manchego	4.5
☐ **Parmesan**	Boar's Head Parmigiano-Reggiano	Kirkland Signature Parmigiano…	4.5
☐ **Pecorino Romano**	Boar's Head Pecorino Romano		Guide
☐ **Asiago Cheese**	Sartori Classic Asiago		Guide
☐ **Fontina Cheese**	Fontina Val d'Aosta DOP		Guide
☐ **Goat Cheese**	Laura Chenel Original Fresh Goat Cheese	Trader Joe's Chèvre	4.7
☐ **Gouda**	Trader Joe's 1000 Day Gouda	Trader Joe's Goat Milk Gouda	4.7
☐ **Blue Cheese**	Point Reyes Original Blue	Trader Joe's Cave Aged Blue	4.5
☐ **Stilton**	Colston Bassett Stilton		Guide
☐ **Gorgonzola Cheese**	Gorgonzola Dolce DOP		Guide
☐ **Truffle Cheese**	Sottocenere al Tartufo		Guide
☐ **Cranberry Cheese**	Wensleydale with Cranberries		Guide
☐ **Fresh Mozzarella**	Primo Taglio Fresh Mozzarella	Trader Joe's Fresh Mozzarella	4.5
☐ **Burrata**	BelGioioso Burrata	Specially Selected Traditional…	4.7
☐ **Ricotta**	BelGioioso Ricotta con Latte		Guide
☐ **Gruyère**	Emmi Kaltbach Le Gruyère AOP	Emmi Le Gruyère AOP	4.4
☐ **Feta**	Mt Vikos Traditional Feta	Athenos Feta Chunk	4.5
☐ **Vegan Cheese**	Boursin Dairy-Free Garlic & Herbs	Violife Mature Cheddar	4.4
☐ **Swiss Cheese**	Sargento Aged Swiss		4.6
☐ **Cream Cheese**	Philadelphia Original Cream Cheese	Great Value Cream Cheese	4.7
☐ **Pimento Cheese**	MyThreeSons Emmy's Original Pimento Ch…	Price's Pimiento Cheese Spread	4.4
☐ **String Cheese**	Frigo Cheese Heads String Cheese		4.2
☐ **Cheese Curds**	Happy Farms White Cheddar Curds (Aldi)		Guide
☐ **Butter (for a butter board)**	Kerrygold Pure Irish Butter (Salted)	Land O Lakes Salted Butter	4.7
☐ **Camembert**	Marin French Cheese Co. Camembert		Guide
☐ **Havarti**	Buholzer Brothers Havarti		Guide
☐ **Provolone**	Boar's Head Picante Provolone	Kroger Smoke Flavored Provol…	4.7
☐ **Pepper Jack Cheese**	Cabot Pepper Jack		4.7
☐ **Herb cheese spreads**	Boursin Garlic & Fine Herbs		Guide
☐ **Cheese balls**	Kaukauna Port Wine Cheese Ball		Guide
CURED MEAT			
☐ **Salami**	Olli Salumeria	Volpi Genoa Salame	4.5
☐ **Deli Meat**	Boar's Head		Guide
☐ **'Nduja**	Tempesta 'Nduja		Guide

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☐ **Prosciutto**	Appleton Farms Prosciutto	Trader Joe's Sliced Prosciutto	4.2
☐ **Jamón Serrano and Spa…**	Redondo Iglesias 16-month Serrano		Guide
☐ **Pepperoni**	Boar's Head Pepperoni	Trader Joe's Ciao Pizza Prima P…	4.5
☐ **Soppressata**	Brooklyn Cured Sweet Soppressata	Volpi Soppressata	4.2
☐ **Spanish Chorizo**	Palacios Chorizo (mild or hot)	Columbus Spanish Style Chori…	4.3
☐ **Summer Sausage**	Cloverdale Original Tangy Summer Sausa…	Trader Joe's Natural Turkey Su…	4.4
☐ **Kielbasa**	Slotkowski Polish Sausage		Guide
☐ **Mortadella**	Columbus Mortadella		4.5
☐ **Smoked Salmon**	Kirkland Signature Smoked Salmon	Latitude 45 Atlantic Salmon (W…	4.7
☐ **Caviar**	Whole Foods Whitefish Caviar (budget)		Guide
☐ **Meat Sticks**	Chomps Original Beef Stick		4.8
☐ **Beef Jerky**	Old Trapper Old Fashioned		Guide
☐ **Capicola (Coppa)**	Volpi Sliced Coppa		Guide
☐ **Pâté**	Les Trois Petits Cochons		Guide
CRACKERS AND CHIPS			
☐ **Water Crackers**	Carr's Table Water Crackers, Original	365 by Whole Foods Market Or…	4.5
☐ **Crackers (all kinds)**	Carr's Table Water Crackers	Milton's Craft Bakers Original M…	4.5
☐ **Gluten-Free Crackers**	Crunchmaster Multi-Seed Crackers	Blue Diamond Nut-Thins	4.7
☐ **Cheese Crisps**	Whisps Parmesan Cheese Crisps		Guide
☐ **Pretzels**	Snack Factory Pretzel Crisps Original	Snyder's of Hanover Snaps	4.7
☐ **Pita Chips**	Stacy's Simply Naked Pita Chips	Specially Selected Sea Salt Pit…	4.7
☐ **Kettle Chips**	Cape Cod Original Sea Salt Kettle Cooked…	Lay's Kettle Cooked Original	4.7
☐ **Tortilla Chips**	On The Border Café Style	Tostitos Original Restaurant St…	4.7
SPREADS AND DIPS			
☐ **Fig Jam**	Dalmatia Original Fig Spread	Bonne Maman Fig Preserves	4.4
☐ **Honey**	Nature Nate's Raw & Unfiltered Honey	365 by Whole Foods Market Or…	4.6
☐ **Mustard**	Maille Old Style Whole Grain Mustard	Grey Poupon Harvest Coarse G…	4.8
☐ **Hot Honey**	Mike's Hot Honey	Nature Nate's Hot Honey	4.5
☐ **Pepper Jelly**	Braswell's Jalapeño Pepper Jelly	Tabasco Spicy Pepper Jelly	4.8
☐ **Balsamic Glaze**	Bertolli Balsamic Glaze		4.7
☐ **Hummus**	Cedar's Classic Original Hummus		4.6
☐ **French Onion Dip**	Heluva Good! French Onion Dip		4.7
☐ **Pesto**	Kirkland Signature Basil Pesto	Good & Gather Basil Pesto	4.7
☐ **Canned Cranberry Sauce**	Ocean Spray Jellied Cranberry Sauce		4.2
☐ **Strawberry Jam**	Bonne Maman Strawberry Preserves	Smucker's Natural Strawberry…	4.8
☐ **Spinach Dip**	Marketside Spinach & Artichoke Dip		4.7
☐ **Queso**	Marketside Queso Blanco	Great Value Salsa Con Queso	4.5

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☐	**Salsa**	Siete Mild Salsa	On The Border Medium Chunk…	4.4
☐	**Guacamole**	Sabra Classic Guacamole	Member's Mark Homestyle Gu…	4.4
☐	**Ranch Dip**	Marie's Creamy Ranch Dressing & Dip	Dean's Ranch Dip	4.4
☐	**Quince Paste (Membrillo)**	Mitica Membrillo		Guide
☐	**Tzatziki**	Boar's Head Tzatziki		Guide
☐	**Whipped Feta Dip**	Trader Joe's Whipped Feta Spread		Guide
☐	**Olive Tapenade**	DeLallo Black Olive Tapenade		Guide
☐	**Buffalo Chicken Dip**	Marketside Buffalo Style Chicken Dip		Guide
☐	**Dill Pickle Dip**	Taste of the South Fried Pickle & Ranch Dip		Guide
	OLIVES, PICKLES AND NUTS			
☐	**Olives**	Mezzetta Castelvetrano Olives	Trader Joe's Organic Conversa…	4.7
☐	**Marcona Almonds**	Trader Joe's Roasted & Salted Rosemary…	Kirkland Signature Marcona Al…	4.5
☐	**Pickles**	Mt. Olive Kosher Baby Dills		4.5
☐	**Mixed nuts**	Kirkland Signature Extra Fancy Salted Mixed Nuts		4.5
☐	**Candied Pecans and Spi…**	Kirkland Signature Praline Pecans		Guide
☐	**Cornichons**	Maille Original Cornichons		Guide
☐	**Marinated Artichoke He…**	Napoleon Marinated Grilled Artichokes		Guide
	SWEETS			
☐	**Dark Chocolate**	Tony's Chocolonely Dark Chocolate 70%	Choceur Dark Chocolate (Aldi)	4.4
☐	**Shortbread**	Walkers Pure Butter Shortbread	Lorna Doone Shortbread Cooki…	4.5
☐	**Christmas cookies**	Pepperidge Farm holiday Milanos		Guide
☐	**Hot Cocoa Mix**	Land O Lakes Chocolate Supreme		Guide
☐	**Panettone**	Olivieri 1882 Classic Panettone		Guide
☐	**Dried fruit**	Mariani Mediterranean Apricots		Guide
☐	**Medjool Dates**	Costco Medjool Dates (value)		Guide
	DRINKS			
☐	**Prosecco**	Mionetto Prosecco Brut	Ruffino Prosecco	4.6
☐	**Champagne under $30**	Kirkland Signature Champagne Brut		Guide
☐	**Port Wine**	Taylor Fladgate 10 Year Tawny		Guide
☐	**Wine under $20**	Segura Viudas Brut Reserva Cava		Guide
☐	**Sparkling cider**	Martinelli's Sparkling Cider		4.8
☐	**Eggnog**	Trader Joe's Egg Nog		Guide

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GIFTS AND GEAR			
☐ **Gift boxes**	Harry & David Ultimate Meat and Cheese Gift Box		4.6
☐ **Gift baskets on Amazon**	Hickory Farms Signature Beef		Guide
☐ **Cheese-of-the-month c…**	Murray's Cheese Explorer's Club		Guide
☐ **Cheese knife sets**	Boska Copenhagen Cheese Knife Set		Guide
☐ **Cheese paper and stora…**	Formaticum Cheese Storage Bags		Guide
☐ **Boards to buy**	A 16-inch-plus hardwood board		Guide
☐ **Board sets on Amazon**	SMIRLY Charcuterie Board Set		Guide
STORE GUIDES: THE TOP PICK AT EACH STORE			
☐ **Trader Joe's cheeses**	Trader Joe's Unexpected Cheddar		4.7
☐ **Trader Joe's meats and…**	Best meat: Trader Joe's Salame di Parma Mild Salami		4.5
☐ **Costco**	Best cheese: Kirkland Signature Manchego DOP		4.5
☐ **Aldi**	Emporium Selection Not Your Average Cheddar		4.7
☐ **Whole Foods Cheeses**	Isigny Sainte-Mère Double Cream Brie		4.3
☐ **Walmart**	Marketside Parmigiano Reggiano, 24 months		4.8
☐ **Sam's Club**	Member's Mark Manchego Wedge		4.8
☐ **Target**	Good & Gather Classic Onion Dip		4.5
☐ **Kroger**	Murray's Cave Aged Stockinghall Cheddar		4.2
☐ **Publix**	Boar's Head Parmigiano Reggiano		4.5
☐ **H-E-B**	Kerrygold Aged Irish Cheddar		4.6
☐ **Wegmans**	Wegmans 18-Month Aged Medium Gouda		4.5
☐ **Safeway and Albertsons**	Laura Chenel Original Fresh Goat Cheese		4.7
☐ **Sprouts**	Sprouts Sliced Pepper Jack and Provolone		Guide
☐ **Lidl**	Preferred Selection Parmigiano Reggiano, 24 months		Guide
☐ **Trader Joe's holiday items**	Creamy Toscano Dusted with Cinnamon		Guide
☐ **Costco holiday items**	Fratelli Beretta Charcuterie Kit		Guide
☐ **Aldi holiday items**	Winter Wonderland Cheese Advent Calendar		Guide